

5. Centre-devised option

This option enables French language learning to be linked to other areas of the curriculum not specified above. It may particularly appeal to centres offering content and language integrated learning (CLIL).

NB: Centres should seek approval from Edexcel, using the *Ask the Expert Service* (see *Section C: Resources, support and training*).

Many students will appreciate the opportunity to focus on **one** broad theme relating to a specific interest or relevant curriculum area. However, it is acknowledged that some centres may wish to cover more than one theme, and this specification accommodates both approaches. Similarly, students can focus on one theme for the speaking unit and on a different one for the writing unit.

The qualification allows for **general, mixed** or **vocationally focused pathways** through the choice of themes. Although *travel and tourism* and *business, work and employment* offer more 'specialist' pathways, they provide **contexts** in which students can apply language skills and do not require any 'specialist' subject knowledge on the part of the student or teacher.

Alongside the themes, Edexcel has set the following four common topic areas and linked sub-topics. These, together with the minimum core generic vocabulary list (*Appendix 5*), have been produced to help teachers in planning and preparing students for the external examinations (*listening and understanding* and *reading and understanding*).

Common topic areas

The papers for listening and reading skills refer to the generic content areas specified below and feature scenarios set in a country where French is spoken. All students, regardless of their chosen pathway and theme(s), will be expected to become familiar with them.

Out and about

- Visitor information
- Basic weather
- Local amenities
- Accommodation
- Public transport
- Directions

Customer service and transactions

- Cafés and restaurants
- Shops
- Dealing with problems

Personal information

- General interests
- Leisure activities
- Family and friends
- Lifestyle (healthy eating and exercise)

Future plans, education and work

- Basic language of the internet
- Simple job advertisements
- Simple job applications and CV
- School and college
- Work and work experience

Unit 1 Listening and understanding in French

Overview

Content overview

To prepare students adequately for this unit, teachers should present and exploit a range of vocabulary relevant to all the common topic areas listed in the *Common Topic Areas* table and, where appropriate, building on the Key Stage 3 Programme of Study. Students should become accustomed to hearing the French language spoken in a range of styles or registers and in a variety of different contexts, as appropriate to their age and level of understanding. Spoken material will feature both male and female voices and represent different age groups. Featured scenarios and situations are generally set in a French-speaking country and students will be expected to develop appropriate cultural awareness and understanding.